

Segment 18 – Echo Lake Rd to Elliott Donnelley Wilderness

(Formerly Segment #17), updated April 2026 [Google Map of Segment 18](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.

Trail Adopters: Jennifer & Brian Jaffe, jdjaffetc@gmail.com

Segment length: About 4.1 miles, east to west 155 ft of ascent, 204 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 41 & 42 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Bob Weisenberger, 906 361-4033, rweisenber@gmail.com) or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (for this segment, the trail description will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound.)

The segment begins at Echo Lake Rd (46.643965,-87.506107). Head into the woods, climbing up a ridge. Follow the ridge and then turn left towards Gokey Rock, then northernly. You will travel along a logging road as you approach the south side of Little Garlic River, then turn right and follow the river to CR 550. Cross the river on CR 550 and enter the Elliott Donnelley Wilderness. (46.674126, -87.543066)..

Driving Directions :

Eastern Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for about 8.7 miles on Hawley St., which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd] to Echo Lake Rd (an unsigned two track). The segment is about .1 miles to the west down Echo Lake Rd (46.643965,-87.506107). Parking is available on an old road area just east of CR 510 (46.645563,-87.504286)

Western Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for about 11 miles on Hawley St., which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd] to the Elliott Donnelley Wilderness parking area on the north side of the Little Garlic River.

Camping:

This segment is a mix of public land, commercial forest, and private land. Do not camp on private land without permission, but dispersed camping is allowed on the public and commercial forest lands.

Water Access:

Water is available via the Little Garlic River on the western end of this segment.

Seasonal Access Information:

CR 550 is drivable year-round. For the eastern trailhead, the parking is sometimes plowed in the wintertime. The Elliott Donnelley Wilderness parking area is not maintained during winter months. There may be limited parking available at a pull off at the turn to Harrison Rd (46.674523,-87.545260). Your wintertime parking option for both trailheads may be along CR 550, which is a busy road.